There has just arrived here a fresh Pasha (the old one is to be removed to Diabekir) his name is Azget Pasha. I happened to be in the street when he was entering the town and as all the people were bowing down almost to the ground I thought I must give him some sort of salute being remarkable from being the only Frank present and from my standing upright, so I touched my cap as he passed to which he bowed very civilly. This Pasha is a strick disciplinarian and a great promoter of the new system of Turkish tactics; it is said that he is going to raise ten thousand regular troops here but this is of course exaggerated.

We arrived here on the 6th; when this letter will go I know not but of course by the first tartar going to Constantinople. I shall keep it open until we start for Tabriz. — The Thermometer this morning (the 19th) at 7 o'clock stood at –0– and it has never been above 6 degrees above it any morning since we came here. Looking from Erz Roum over the plain you see nothing but snow, not a tree, not a bush, to relieve the eye. You here and there see about three small villages but these have no trees about them and are only distinguished from the plain by the mud walls of the houses showing black, amid the waste of snow. What a contrast from Constantinople and Trebisond, the latter in particular is surrounded with mountains the tops covered with snow and the sides clothed with roderdendrums, arbutus myrtle and other shrubs mostly evergreen.

At Trebisond we had two days shooting in company with a Mr. Abbot a young man who came there with Mr. Brant: I am no shot (at least at birds flying, a bullet at a still mark I shoot well) and cannot boast of ever having struck a bird flying except ducks and these are in such numbers all along this coast and are always in flocks that a man might almost shoot them blindfold.

(21st) I have left Mr. Zorab and Charles in another room and am now (about 8 P. M.) squatting on my carpet with C's desk on my knees finishing this letter. Close to my hand are my pistols (this is a regular practice; travellers in Turkey when on the road never sit down without their pistols close at hand) and sitting on the floor near me is an Armenian servant casting up his accounts. Behind me leaned against the wall are my double barrelled gun and Turkish sword and my cartridge box lies on the carpet close to them. All around lie cloaks, coats, trunks, blankets Turkish slippers and other travellers traps. At one end of the room is a wood fire on each side of which Charles' and my carpets are and firewood but, at the other end of the room is the door, some cupboards and a sort of gallery over the cupboards. The windows are three in number one foot long by four inches in width of one pane of glass, quite at the top of the room. You now have a description of our room which is much like all the better sort of rooms that I have seen here except that glass is a great rarity and only to be found in the best description of houses; oiled paper is substitution in all the inferior ones.

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